

Managing and Reducing Known Risks Matrix

VERSION 1.0	EFFECTIVE	NEXT REVIEW	OWNER Principal / Key Management Personnel	APPROVED BY Governing body
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Read with the Work Health and Safety Policy and Risk Management Policy. This matrix lists common hazards in disability support work, the risk factors that make each more likely, and possible controls. Use it as a prompt when completing the Risk Register and the Client Risk Assessment Form, and add site- and participant-specific controls.

KNOWN HAZARD OR RISK	RISK FACTORS	POSSIBLE CONTROLS
Manual tasks	Support may involve handling people in their homes — transferring, bathing and dressing participants, pushing wheelchairs, loading and unloading equipment, and repetitive or sustained postures. Risk rises with a lack of equipment, confined spaces, unpredictable movement and inadequate training.	• Complete a manual-tasks / home safety risk assessment for each participant and workplace • Provide and maintain hoists, slide sheets, transfer aids and adjustable equipment • Train workers in safe manual handling with refreshers; document participant-specific transfer methods in the support plan • Use two workers where assessed as required; report and review any strain or near-miss
Work-related violence and aggression	Workers can be exposed to violence from participants, their networks or others where services are provided. Risk rises with behaviours of concern, substance use in the home, isolation, and unclear behaviour support.	• Assess each participant and environment before support starts; record known triggers and de-escalation strategies • Follow the participant's behaviour support plan; train workers in communication and safer de-escalation • Enable workers to report aggression without consequence; review access to services where safety cannot be assured • Provide access to psychological support; brief and debrief workers
Work-related stress	Physical, mental and emotional reactions when work demands are perceived to exceed a worker's abilities or resources — heavy caseloads, exposure to trauma, long or unsociable hours, and lone work.	• Manage rostering and caseloads; ensure breaks and two full days off when working long hours • Provide regular supervision (Worker Supervision Record) and access to an employee assistance program • Encourage early reporting of stress; adjust duties where reasonably practicable
Remote or isolated work	Work undertaken when isolated from the assistance of others — including rescue, medical assistance and emergency services — because of location, time or the nature of the work.	• Maintain a check-in / check-out system for lone workers; confirm safe arrival and departure • Ensure reliable communication (charged phone, coverage check) and a means to raise an alarm • Plan for a duress response; provide first aid training and a stocked first aid kit
Biological hazards and infection	Exposure of workers and participants to infection — including through personal care, waste handling and outbreaks. Some infectious diseases require particular precautions.	• Apply standard precautions in all settings — hand hygiene, respiratory hygiene, cough etiquette • Provide and train workers in the use of PPE; make PPE available to participants who require it • Follow the Infection Control and COVID-19 Pandemic Management policies; routine environmental cleaning outside participants' homes • Support worker immunisation where relevant; exclude unwell workers
Slips, trips, falls and the home environment	Uneven or wet surfaces, clutter, poor lighting, trailing cords, pets, and unfamiliar homes.	• Complete a WHS walk-around risk assessment of each participant's home • Agree reasonable adjustments with the participant; report and follow up hazards • Wear suitable footwear; keep walkways clear during support

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Driving and transport	Transporting participants — fatigue, distraction, vehicle condition, and participant behaviour in the vehicle.	• Verify licences and driving records; maintain and check vehicles before trips • Plan routes and rest breaks; follow safe-transport procedures and secure restraints and equipment • Record and manage any incident during transport